incomplete information can be more valuable than one that merely demonstrates technical proficiency. The objective is not simply to acquire a job-ready skill but to develop a career-ready capability.

Fourth, deliberately cultivate the human capabilities that machines cannot easily replicate. Communication, collaboration, persuasion, empathy, ethical reasoning, leadership and the ability to build trust will remain central to management. A future leader will have to orchestrate human and machine intelligence while retaining accountability for the decision. That requires knowing not merely what is possible, but what is desirable and responsible.

Finally, become interdisciplinary. The problems of tomorrow will not arrive neatly labelled as marketing, finance, operations, or human resources. Climate change, AI, geopolitics, demographic shifts and social expectations cut across disciplines. Excessive disciplinary silos and information-heavy assessments must give way to real-world problems, interdisciplinary learning, decision-making, reflection and ethical dilemmas.

This has implications for business schools as well. AI cannot be treated merely as another technology elective. It needs to be woven through management education. The faculty member is evolving from an information provider into a mentor, facilitator, intellectual provocateur and curator of judgement.

At IIM Kozhikode, we are already seeing this transition. Digital and AI tools are increasingly woven into the learning experience, while courses spanning AI for business, customer analytics, strategic analytics, fintech, computational advertising, and digital business transformation expose students to the opportunities and implications of emerging technologies. But experimentation is not transformation. Experimentation asks, "What can AI do?" Transformation asks, "What should education become because AI exists?" That transformation requires changes in curriculum, pedagogy, assessment, faculty roles and the student experience. The real test of AI adoption is not how many tools a business school uses, but whether those tools improve learning, decision-making, and outcomes.

The purpose of management education was never simply to produce people who know more than machines. It is to produce people who can think, judge, lead, and care.

The future-ready business school will, therefore, have to combine AI capability with human wisdom, technological innovation with ethical responsibility, and efficiency with meaning.

As AI transforms the world, the MBA must transform, too. The MBA of the future may indeed be a Master of Business Ambiguity. And its graduates will need something more than answers: they will need the wisdom to know which questions are worth asking. BT

Views are personal

ILLUSTRATION BY **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

